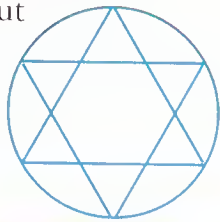


Judaism spreads throughout western Asia.

Star of David



2,000

Ancient Greek civilization is at its peak. The Parthenon is built in Athens.

Greek vase



500

Buddhism starts in India with the birth of its founder, Siddhartha Gautama.



563

The **Chinese Empire** begins when Shih Juang-ti unites China, and becomes its first emperor.

Shih Juang-ti



221

The prophet **Muhammed** begins the religion of Islam.



622

Vikings from Scandinavia travel widely to find new lands and trading partners.

800



Viking longship

Christian Crusaders from Europe fight to regain control of Jerusalem from the Muslims.

Crusaders



1096-1291

Italian-born **Christopher Columbus** crosses the Atlantic Ocean.

Astrolabe



1492

The world is **round**, not flat. This was discovered by Spanish explorers.

1500



Japan stops all contact with foreigners and the outside world for the next 200 years.

1639



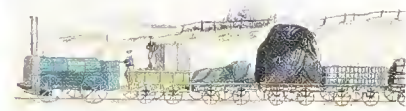
The **slave trade** grows. Many Africans are seized and shipped to America.

1600-1800

The **French Revolution** brings down the monarchy in France.



1789



Steam trains are invented. They are powered by wood or coal.

1830

Maori rebellion in New Zealand ends British rule. New Zealand is allowed to govern itself.

1850

Civil War breaks out between the states of America. Slaves are set free.

1861



World War I is fought in Europe.

1914-1918

The **Russian Revolution** overthrows the Tzar. Lenin becomes the new communist leader.

Vladimir Illich Lenin

1917



The **Great Depression** is a time of great hardship in the US.

1929

World War II breaks out after German leader Hitler invades Poland.

British fighter plane



1939-1945



The **Vietnam War** is fought. American troops help South Vietnam.

1965-1973



Neil Armstrong is the first person to walk on the Moon.

1969

The **Berlin Wall** comes down as East and West Germany reunite.

1989



Nelson Mandela becomes president of South Africa.

1994